

The Antique Sword

Detective Jabardast and his assistant Sawalkar were in an **antique** store when Ayaz Ahmed, the **wealthy** businessman **walked in**. Ayaz Ahmed was known to be a great **connoisseur** of art and the owner of that antique store looked **eager** to show him.

"Take a look at this sword, Sir!" said the owner, his eyes **shining** with **excitement**. "It's **ancient**!"

Ayaz Ahmed wanted to know how old the sword was and to whom it had belonged.

"To Haidar Ali, the ruler of Mysore, Sir!" replied the owner.

The detective's **curiosity** was **aroused** on hearing this and he went close to inspect the sword.

"How can you prove that it belonged to Haidar Ali?" the detective asked the owner of the shop.

"Well," replied the owner. "Take a look at the **inscription** on the sword!"

The detective looked closely at the inscription. "It's in Urdu," he said. "Can you read it out to me?"

"Let me try. I know a **smattering** of Urdu," said Ayaz Ahmed, taking the sword in his hands. "It says, 'To our beloved soldiers in the First Mysore War.'

This sword was presented to him on the 4th of April, 1769 by his loyal soldiers.'"

"Wow!" said Sawalkar.

"Sure is a beauty! Tell me the price you have in mind for it," said Ayaz Ahmed to the owner.

"Don't buy it! It's a fake!" said the detective with **certainty** and handed back the sword.



Sawalkar **wondered** what made the detective doubt its originality and asked him about it on their way back.

"Very simple, dear Sawalkar," replied the detective, **shrugging** his shoulders. "You see, this sword, although of Mysore was in all, three hundred years old. Further, 1769. So, how could Haidar Ali's soldiers have known that they had fought the First Mysore War?"

Vocabulary

1. **Antique** (adjective) – vintage, timeworn, age-old, archaic, olden प्राचीन
2. **Wealthy** (adjective) – rich, affluent, prosperous, well-off, moneyed धनी
3. **Walk in** (phrasal verb) – enter, step in, come in, stroll in, saunter in अंदर आना
4. **Connoisseur** (noun) – expert, authority, specialist, judge, aficionado पारखी
5. **Eager** (adjective) – keen, enthusiastic, avid, zealous, impatient उत्सुक
6. **Shine** (verb) – gleam, glisten, sparkle, glow, beam चमकना
7. **Excitement** (noun) – enthusiasm, thrill, exhilaration, buzz, eagerness उत्साह
8. **Ancient** (adjective) – age-old, timeworn, primeval, bygone, centuries-old प्राचीन
9. **Curiosity** (noun) – inquisitiveness, interest, intrigue, wonderment, nosiness जिज्ञासा
10. **Arouse** (verb) – stir, kindle, awaken, provoke, trigger जगाना
11. **Inscription** (noun) – engraving, epigraph, lettering, carving, legend अभिलेख
12. **Smattering** (noun) – modicum, bit, sprinkling, smidge, fragment थोड़ी-सी जानकारी
13. **Certainty** (noun) – sureness, conviction, confidence, assurance, definiteness निश्चितता
14. **Wonder** (verb) – ponder, marvel, question, muse, speculate सोचना
15. **Shrug** (verb) – raise shoulders, hitch, shrug off, dismiss, brush aside (कंधे) उचकाना



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